

Primary Source Annotation 6: Memory and Testimony

Due: Friday, December 4 at 11:59 PM

Value: 30 points

Format: 600-word oral-history annotation

Purpose

Treat remembered testimony as evidence about both a past event and the later moment in which memory was narrated.

Your task

- Choose one approved transcript excerpt on Holocaust survival, Partition migration, Algerian independence, Japanese American incarceration, or postwar guest-worker experience.
- Identify narrator, interviewer, interview date, archive, time elapsed, and the project's stated purpose.
- Analyze two moments where narrative structure, later knowledge, silence, emotion, or interviewer prompting shapes the account.
- Explain what the testimony reveals uniquely and how you would corroborate one factual claim without dismissing memory as 'unreliable.'

Submit

- 600-word annotation PDF with citation to the interview and archive.

Important note

Use only course-approved public archive excerpts. Do not speculate about a narrator's mental health or motives.

Grading criteria

Criterion	Pts	Full-credit evidence
Context	7	Accurately situates creator, audience, place, and historical moment.
Close reading	9	Analyzes two specific features of the source with careful evidence.
Interpretation	8	Makes a defensible claim and distinguishes inference from fact.
Limits and citation	6	Names silences or limits and supplies a complete Chicago citation.

Submission standards

Upload a readable PDF unless the handout specifies another format. Include your name, course code, and assignment title. Cite borrowed ideas and retain the editable source file. The learning portal timestamp is the official submission time.